

POLICY ON THE ESTABLISHMENT AND OPERATION OF THE COLEOPTERA RESEARCH CENTER

Rationale

The Coleoptera Research Center (CRC) is the premier center in the Philippines devoted to the study and conservation of Philippine beetles. It was established to answer the need for a center that will lead in the research and conservation of Philippine beetles, provide a repository area for references and collections, establish a Philippine beetle database, be at the forefront in the discovery of new beetle species, provide baseline data for conservation management actions, and provide trainings and capability building to promote coleopterological studies in the Philippines.

Established in 2018 through a collaboration between the University of Mindanao and Daugavpils University, Latvia, under the ERASMUS+ Mobility Program, the CRC was created in response to the growing need for a dedicated research and conservation institution that focuses on Philippine beetles and their ecological significance. Since its inception, the CRC has served as the premier center in the Philippines for beetle research and conservation, providing a repository for species collections, maintaining the Philippine Beetle Database, leading the discovery of new species, and generating scientific evidence to guide conservation management and policy development.

Through its research and education programs, the CRC contributes to the understanding and protection of species and habitats associated with the University's operations. The Center's activities align with the University's mandate to promote environmental stewardship and support the achievement of national and international biodiversity goals.

Vision

To be the leading center in the Philippines in the advancement and promotion of Philippine beetle research and conservation.

Mission

Our mission is to advance and promote research and conservation of beetles in the Philippines through conducting field exploration, writing scientific papers, engaging with local and international collaborators, partnering with various stakeholders such as LGUs, NGO's, local schools, and communities, and conducting various education programs to train the next generation of coleopterists.

Goals

The Coleoptera Research Center aims:

1. To conduct field explorations, especially in all entomologically unexplored mountain ecosystems, Key Biodiversity Areas, and protected areas in the Philippines, to provide baseline data on beetles.

2. To lead in the discovery of new species of beetles.
3. To provide a repository area for reference collection.
4. To provide an online and offline database for beetles and beetle studies in the Philippines.
5. To engage and develop partnerships with international and local collaborators, various stakeholder such as LGU's, NGO's, local universities, research institutions, basic education and communities in conducting research and conservation activities exclusive to beetles.
6. To stimulate and participate in research that will (1) fill knowledge gaps about the beetles and (2) conduct conservation activities.
7. To provide trainings and capacity building to LGU's, NGO's, local schools and communities in conducting beetle researches.
8. To lead in the writing and distribution of books, laboratory manuals and IEC materials to promote beetle research and conservation.
9. To produce the first journal devoted to beetles in the Philippines.

Governance and Oversight

The CRC shall be managed under the supervision of the Institute of Biodiversity and Environment (IBE) and the Office of the Vice President for Research and Innovation Center. The CRC Director shall oversee the implementation of research programs, partnerships, and compliance with national and institutional policies.

Operational Policies

Policies for Collaboration

1. Mutual interest should be manifested in each collaborative endeavor. Collaborations with foreign researchers and scientists should be mutually beneficial. UM coleoptera researchers should never be used only as collectors by foreign scientists. Joint publications, joint research grants, or any common project should be undertaken as a result of the collaboration.
2. As a member of the research team of the Coleoptera Research Center, sending specimens to foreign collaborators should be consulted first with the AVP for Innovations and Natural Sciences or the Coordinator of the Coleoptera Research Center.
3. The CRC research team should never accompany or guide insect collectors, but only those involved in legitimate work on research and conservation of beetles/insects.
4. If a member of the Coleoptera Research Center research team, collaborations should be properly consulted with the AVP for Innovations and Natural Sciences or the Coordinator of the Coleoptera Research Center. This is to avoid conflicts of interest between different groups of taxonomists.

Policies for Publication

1. All research produced by and funded by the Coleoptera Research Center shall give 10% of its incentive to the Center. The fund will be kept as an emergency fund and will be utilized in doing short fieldwork and used as a seed grant for students' short research expeditions.

2. In terms of authorship, the lead author shall have the main contribution to the paper and is involved in either data gathering, analysis of the data, identification of the specimens, scientific writing, proofreading, and sending of the manuscript to the journal. Second, third, and the rest of the authors shall have pertinent contributions to the paper and may be involved in some of the job descriptions mentioned above. Authors with no pertinent contribution to the paper shall not be included.
3. When using the permit of collaborators, only 1 author shall be included from the group who loaned the permit in every paper, or as decided by the lead author.
4. If collaborators will provide the specimens for joint publication, the CRC research team and the collaborators will decide who will be the lead author, depending on who will do the bulk of the task in the scientific writing. Collaborators can be lead authors in ecologic and faunistic papers and can include as many authors as possible if they will be the ones to work on the paper. If the collaborators will only give specimens for identification, the CRC research team will decide who will be the lead author and who will be included in the publication.
5. If the collaborators will provide the specimens for joint publication, taxonomic papers will be done by the CRC research team and will only include one author from the collaborators' team. If the collaborator wants to write a taxonomic paper, the CRC research team will guide and help the collaborator in writing such papers, but the collaborator should be the one to work on the description.
6. For the description of a new species, the lead author will have the sole authority over who to include in the publication and decide on the name of the species. Co-authors can only suggest, but the final say will be given to the lead author. If a member of the research team of CRC is asked by a foreign collaborator as a co-author, there is no need for him or her to adhere to the above-mentioned policies.

Policies for Identification and Deposition of Specimens

1. For identification of species, the CRC research team will not charge, but at least 1 or 2 replicates of the specimens should be deposited at the center.
2. Online identification is not allowed and will only be allowed with the consent of the AVP for Natural Science and Innovation and the Coordinator of the CRC. Students asking for online identification should write a letter to the AVP for consent.

Policies for Field Work

1. During joint fieldwork with local or foreign collaborators, specimens collected by UM team and collaborators, both parties can keep their specimens. However, for the endemic and threatened species, collaborators should deposit 10% of each species at the Coleoptera Research Center.

Policies for Ethics and Intellectual Property

1. The CRC research team should never be involved in the selling of specimens or be associated with poachers.
2. The CRC research team is not allowed to share the CRC Coleoptera database and information unless agreed upon by the center's director or the AVP of the institute. Copyright laws should be properly observed.

3. Members of the research team of CRC are prohibited from sharing pertinent information, such as new species being described, localities of threatened and endemic species, and other information that may compromise the work at the center.
4. Workers and collaborators who plan to be part of the research team of the Coleoptera Research Center shall abide by the abovementioned policies.

Signed:

(Sgd) GUILLERMO P. TORRES, JR.
University President

References

DENR Administrative Order No. 2019-09: Updated National List of Threatened Philippine Fauna and Their Categories
International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN) Red List of Threatened Species
Philippine Biodiversity Strategy and Action Plan (PBSAP) 2015-2028
United Nations Sustainable Development Goal 15: Life on Land